

· MODULE N · DIAGNOSTICS

· UPDATED v2 · 3.2

Identify

and correct

the 5

most

common

causes ·

including the

new

tools.profile

and the

BotFather

privacy

mode.

LESSON

N-2

DURATION

~15 min

LEVEL

Intermediate

VERSION

3.2 ·

Bot

without

access

to the shell

N-2 · BOT WITHOUT SHELL

v2 · OpenClaw 3.2

01 Symptoms

How to know if you have this problem

· Classic Symptoms

The agent says: "I can't execute commands on your system"

The agent responds fluently with text, but any system task fails

Errors such as exec: not in allowlist , Permission denied , Sandbox restriction

Bot added to the group · doesn't respond at all (not even errors)

· Quick test

Ask the agent to execute echo "SHELL_TEST_OK" . If you receive the text back, shell OK. If it gives an error · you have one of the problems below.

· Diagnostic Flowchart

Follow this order · solves 95% of cases

Bot doesn't execute commands?

·

·

tools.profile = "messaging"? · YES... Remove or change to "default"

· NO

·

Bot in group and doesn't respond? · YES... BotFather · disable Group Privacy

· NO

·

sandbox = "all" ? · YES... Change to "off" or "non-main"

· NO

·

security = "deny" ? · YES... Change to "allowlist"

· NO

·

"exec" in allowlist? · NO... Add "exec" to allowlist

· YES

·

openclaw gateway restart

·

·

·

·

echo "SHELL_TEST_OK" · OK? · Solved · View logs

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N-2 · AS 5 CAUSAS

v2 · OpenClaw 3.2

02 As 5 Causas

· CAUSA 0 · MAIS COMUM · NOVO 3.2

tools.profile = "messaging"

NEW

Since 3.2, the #1 cause of "bot does nothing" is tools.profile configured as messaging . This profile optimizes the agent to respond to text on Telegram/ WhatsApp · but blocks exec and system access.

CAUSE 1

exec is not in the allowlist

The agent has a list of allowed tools. If exec is not on it, no command runs.

CAUSE 2

```
{
  "agents": { "main": { "tools": {
    "profile": "messaging"
  // · PROBLEM
  }}}
}
json
// CORRECTION: change to "default" or remove the key
{
  "agents": { "main": { "tools": {
    "profile": "default"
  // · CORRECTION
  }}}
}
json
{
  "agents": { "main": { "tools": {
    "allowlist": ["exec", "read", "write", "edit", "web_search"]
  }}}
}
json
```

Sandbox all without correct permission

With sandbox: "all", even the main agent is isolated. Use off for the main agent or non-main to sandbox only sub-agents.

VALUE

BEHAVIOR

off

No sandbox · full access to the system

non-main

Sandbox only in sub-agents

all

Sandbox in everyone · includes main agent ··

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N-2 · CAUSES 3, 4, 5

v2 · OpenClaw 3.2

CAUSE 3

Security mode deny

With security: "deny", the agent blocks any command execution. Change to allowlist.

CAUSE 4 · TELEGRAM GROUP

BotFather Group Privacy Mode

Bot works in DM but ignores messages in the group? It's BotFather's Group Privacy Mode · active by default. With privacy C

· How to disable

Open @BotFather on Telegram

Send: /mybots · select your bot

Click "Bot Settings"

Click "Group Privacy"

Click "Turn off"

Confirmation: "Privacy mode is disabled"

· Remove and re-add the bot to the group!

CAUSE 5 · VPS

Shell path not found

More common in VPS, Docker containers and minimalist distributions. OpenClaw can't find the shell.

```
{  
  "agents": { "main": {  
    "security": "allowlist"  
  }  
}
```

// was "deny"

```
}}
```

```
}
```

json

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

Confirm the path: run which bash or which sh in the server terminal.

```
{  
  "agents": { "main": {  
    "shell": "/bin/bash"  
    // or "/bin/sh" in Alpine  
  }}  
}
```

json

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N-2 · VERIFICATION & PROMPT

v2 · OpenClaw 3.2

03 Post-Correction Checklist

· Verification

Restart gateway: openclaw gateway restart

Check status: openclaw gateway status

Basic test: ask the agent echo "SHELL_TEST_OK"

File test: touch /tmp/teste-openclaw /& echo "OK"

Check logs: openclaw gateway logs /-tail 20

Test real task: "list the files in the current directory"

If group bot: test message in the group after re-adding

04 Summary of Causes

·Diagnostic Prompt

Use the prompts/aula-n2-bot-sem-shell-prompt-aluno.md file · paste it into the agent's chat for automatic interactive diagnosis

#

CAUSE

CORRECTION

0 ·

tools.profile = "messaging"

Switch to "default" or remove

1

exec not in allowlist

Add "exec" to the allowlist

2

Sandbox "all"

Change to "off" or "non-main"

3

Security "deny"

Change to "allowlist"

4

BotFather Privacy Mode (group)

Disable Group Privacy in BotFather

5

Shell path not found

Configure "shell": "/bin/bash"

.

NEXT CLASS

N-4 · Slowness in Telegram: causes and fixes

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